

Sinclair ZX80/ZX81 Emulator User Guide

ZX80 AND ZX81 ROM VARIANTS: STARTUP OPTIONS AND
COMMAND CONSOLE REFERENCE

IGNACIO CEA FORNIÉS

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Foreword

This guide describes the startup and command interfaces implemented by the two Sinclair ZX80/ZX81 executables in EMULATORS: ZX81Emulator (without a local command console) and ZX81EmulatorC (with a local command console). It covers the ZX80 and the three ZX81 ROM selectors and is based on both executable entry points, the ZX81::ZX81Emulator inheritance chain, LocalConsole, and the complete ZX81 -> SINCLAIR -> StandardCommandBuilder responsibility chain.

Command and parameter names are shown exactly as accepted by the current code. Startup options use /XVALUE with no space between the one-letter option and its value. Command names are matched as written by the builders; use uppercase names for reliable operation. Positional command parameters are separated by spaces; examples use paths without embedded spaces.

The non-console executable does not expose an interactive prompt. When started with /o it creates a remote communication system using the same ZX80/ZX81, Sinclair and standard command builders. Commands marked Local console only are intercepted by LocalConsole and therefore cannot be sent to the non-console executable.

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1. Startup Parameters: Version Without a Local Console

Executable: ZX81Emulator.exe. It accepts the framework and ZX80/ZX81-specific options below, plus /o and the communication-port option. Option letters are case-sensitive because the command-line parser stores the character exactly as supplied.

/o

Meaning: Controls creation of the remote command communication system.

General form:

```
/o[YES|NO]
```

- YES or an empty value: open remote communications.
- NO (and any other non-YES non-empty value): do not open it.
- Omitted: remote communications disabled.

Examples:

```
ZX81Emulator.exe /o  
ZX81Emulator.exe /oYES /p60000
```

Consequence: When enabled, remote clients can execute ZX80/ZX81, Sinclair and standard builder commands. LocalConsole-only commands remain unavailable.

/p

Meaning: Selects the TCP listening port used by the non-console executable's remote command channel.

General form:

```
/pPORTNUMBER
```

- 0 through 65535: requested listening port; values above 1000 are recommended.
- Omitted: port 60000 is used when /o enables the channel.
- Collision: the inherited emulator also interprets /p as a comma-separated peripheral-ID list. A supplied port number is therefore also attempted as a peripheral ID during initialization.

Examples:

```
ZX81Emulator.exe /o  
ZX81Emulator.exe /o /p61000
```

Consequence: The remote server listens on the selected port. When /p is present, the same value is also passed to peripheral startup and normally produces a log warning because a port number is not a valid peripheral ID.

/h

Meaning: Prints the executable help and prevents the emulation from starting.

General form:

```
/h
```

- No value.

Examples:

```
ZX81Emulator.exe /h
```

Consequence: Initialization returns failure after printing the help; the current main program therefore exits with code 1.

/f

Meaning: Loads a binary file whose header contains the destination address.

General form:

```
/fFILE
```

- FILE: path to the header-addressed binary file; attach it directly to /f.

Examples:

```
ZX81Emulator.exe /fprogram.bin  
ZX81Emulator.exe /fgames\demo.prg /a$080d
```

Consequence: The file is loaded before execution. An unreadable or invalid file aborts initialization.

/k

Meaning: Loads a block-structured memory file.

General form:

```
/kFILE
```

- FILE: path to a block file understood by the framework.

Examples:

```
ZX81Emulator.exe /ksnapshot.blocks
```

Consequence: Every encoded block is placed at its stored address. A load error aborts initialization.

/c

Meaning: Parses, assembles and loads an assembler source file.

General form:

```
/cFILE
```

- FILE: assembler source path.

Examples:

```
ZX81Emulator.exe /cstartup.asm /s
```


Consequence: The assembled bytes are installed before the main loop. Syntax or load errors are logged and initialization stops.

/l

Meaning: Selects the framework diagnostic level.

General form:

```
/lLEVEL
```

- 0: no diagnostics.
- 1: errors (default).
- 2: dump at exit.
- 3: errors and warnings.
- 4: all regular diagnostics.
- 5: internal trace diagnostics.

Examples:

```
ZX81Emulator.exe /l0  
ZX81Emulator.exe /l4
```

Consequence: Higher values produce progressively more diagnostic output and may reduce performance.

/a

Meaning: Overrides the address at which execution begins.

General form:

```
/aADDRESS
```

- ADDRESS: ZX80/ZX81 address in the framework number syntax, for example decimal or hexadecimal with \$.

Examples:

```
ZX81Emulator.exe /a$080d  
ZX81Emulator.exe /fprogram.bin /a2061
```

Consequence: A non-zero, valid address replaces the normal reset/program entry address.

/d

Meaning: Creates startup stop points at one or more addresses.

General form:

```
/dADDRESS1,ADDRESS2,...
```

- ADDRESSn: comma-separated address. Each entry accepts the framework number syntax.

Examples:

```
ZX81Emulator.exe /d$080d  
ZX81Emulator.exe /d$080d,$ffd2 /s
```

Consequence: Execution stops when the CPU reaches any listed address, allowing later inspection or continuation.

/s

Meaning: Controls whether the emulated computer starts stopped.

General form:

```
/s[YES|NO]
```

- YES or an empty value: start stopped.
- NO (and any non-YES non-empty value): start running.
- Omitted: start running.

Examples:

```
ZX81Emulator.exe /s  
ZX81Emulator.exe /sNO
```

Consequence: When enabled, the machine is initialized but the CPU does not run until a RUN/NEXT command or the equivalent UI action is issued.

/i

Meaning: Selects the language identifier exposed to the emulated machine.

General form:

```
/iLANG
```

- ENG: English; this is the only language advertised and supported by the ZX80/ZX81 emulator.

Examples:

```
ZX81Emulator.exe /iENG
```

Consequence: The machine starts with the English language identifier. Other values are passed through but have no documented ZX80/ZX81 ROM variant in this implementation.

/r

Meaning: Requests the initial sound-output state.

General form:

```
/r[YES|NO]
```

- YES or an empty value: requests sound enabled.
- NO (and any other non-YES non-empty value): requests sound disabled.
- Omitted: requests sound enabled.

Examples:

```
ZX81Emulator.exe /r  
ZX81Emulator.exe /rNO
```

Consequence: The option is parsed, but the implemented ZX80/ZX81 computer has no sound device, so initialization makes no audio-state change.

/g

Meaning: Controls the CRT post-processing effect at startup.

General form:

```
/g[YES|NO]
```

- YES or an empty value: CRT effect enabled.
- NO (and any non-YES non-empty value): disabled.
- Omitted: disabled.

Examples:

```
ZX81Emulator.exe /g  
ZX81Emulator.exe /gNO
```

Consequence: The screen starts with or without CRT emulation. CRTON and CRTOFF can change it later.

/n

Meaning: Requests NTSC visualization parameters.

General form:

```
/n
```

- No value: the presence of the option requests NTSC.

Examples:

```
ZX81Emulator.exe /mZX813 /n
```

Consequence: The current factory always constructs PAL ZX80 and ZX81 machines. The option is detected and a limitation is written to the log, but PAL timing and screen geometry remain active.

/w

Meaning: Selects the startup RAM configuration.

General form:

```
/wCONF
```

- ZX80: only configuration 0 (unexpanded) is implemented; another value is ignored and logged.
- ZX81 ROM variants, 0 or omitted: unexpanded configuration (default).
- ZX81 ROM variants, 1: 16 KiB expansion.
- ZX81 ROM variants, any value other than 0 or 1: reset to unexpanded configuration and logged.

Examples:

```
ZX81Emulator.exe /mZX80 /w0  
ZX81Emulator.exe /mZX813 /w1
```

Consequence: The selected memory map is installed before the ROM and machine initialize. The broader 3K/8K/24K list in an old header comment is not implemented by the current factory.

/b

Meaning: Draws a diagnostic grid around the writable screen area and selects its color.

General form:

```
/b[COLOR]
```

- COLOR omitted or 0: black (default).
- 1 through 15: the requested grid color.
- Any value greater than 15: clamped to 15.

Examples:

```
ZX81Emulator.exe /b  
ZX81Emulator.exe /b14
```

Consequence: The screen is initialized with the diagnostic grid enabled in the selected color.

/m

Meaning: Selects the ZX80 or ZX81 ROM variant to emulate.

General form:

```
/mMACHINE
```

- ZX80: ZX80 model and ROM; this is the default when /m is omitted.
- ZX811: ZX81 with the old ROM image.
- ZX812: ZX81 with the rare/intermediate ROM image.
- ZX813: ZX81 with the newest ROM image.
- Any other value: logs the unsupported selector and falls back to ZX80.

Examples:

```
ZX81Emulator.exe /mZX80  
ZX81Emulator.exe /mZX811  
ZX81Emulator.exe /mZX813 /w1
```

Consequence: The selector chooses the ROM image and machine type created before initialization. It does not independently select a ULA silicon revision, video standard or RAM expansion.

2. Startup Parameters: Version With a Local Console

Executable: ZX81EmulatorC.exe. Its main program delegates the complete command line to ZX81::ZX81Emulator, so all inherited framework options and ZX80/ZX81-specific options are active even though the short main-level help banner only advertises /h. It has no /o listener option; commands are entered in its local console.

/h

Meaning: Prints the executable help and prevents the emulation from starting.

General form:

```
/h
```

- No value.

Examples:

```
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /h
```

Consequence: Initialization returns failure after printing the help; the current main program therefore exits with code 1.

/f

Meaning: Loads a binary file whose header contains the destination address.

General form:

```
/fFILE
```

- FILE: path to the header-addressed binary file; attach it directly to /f.

Examples:

```
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /fprogram.bin  
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /fgames\demo.prg /a$080d
```

Consequence: The file is loaded before execution. An unreadable or invalid file aborts initialization.

/k

Meaning: Loads a block-structured memory file.

General form:

```
/kFILE
```

- FILE: path to a block file understood by the framework.

Examples:

```
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /ksnapshot.blocks
```

Consequence: Every encoded block is placed at its stored address. A load error aborts initialization.

/c

Meaning: Parses, assembles and loads an assembler source file.

General form:

```
/cFILE
```

- FILE: assembler source path.

Examples:

```
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /cstartup.asm /s
```

Consequence: The assembled bytes are installed before the main loop. Syntax or load errors are logged and initialization stops.

/l

Meaning: Selects the framework diagnostic level.

General form:

```
/lLEVEL
```

- 0: no diagnostics.
- 1: errors (default).
- 2: dump at exit.
- 3: errors and warnings.
- 4: all regular diagnostics.
- 5: internal trace diagnostics.

Examples:

```
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /l0  
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /l4
```

Consequence: Higher values produce progressively more diagnostic output and may reduce performance.

/a

Meaning: Overrides the address at which execution begins.

General form:

```
/aADDRESS
```

- ADDRESS: ZX80/ZX81 address in the framework number syntax, for example decimal or hexadecimal with \$.

Examples:

```
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /a$080d  
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /fprogram.bin /a2061
```

Consequence: A non-zero, valid address replaces the normal reset/program entry address.

/d

Meaning: Creates startup stop points at one or more addresses.

General form:

```
/dADDRESS1,ADDRESS2,...
```

- ADDRESSn: comma-separated address. Each entry accepts the framework number syntax.

Examples:

```
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /d$080d  
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /d$080d,$ffd2 /s
```

Consequence: Execution stops when the CPU reaches any listed address, allowing later inspection or continuation.

/s

Meaning: Controls whether the emulated computer starts stopped.

General form:

```
/s[YES|NO]
```

- YES or an empty value: start stopped.
- NO (and any non-YES non-empty value): start running.
- Omitted: start running.

Examples:

```
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /s  
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /sNO
```

Consequence: When enabled, the machine is initialized but the CPU does not run until a RUN/NEXT command or the equivalent UI action is issued.

/i

Meaning: Selects the language identifier exposed to the emulated machine.

General form:

```
/iLANG
```

- ENG: English; this is the only language advertised and supported by the ZX80/ZX81 emulator.

Examples:

```
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /iENG
```

Consequence: The machine starts with the English language identifier. Other values are passed through but have no documented ZX80/ZX81 ROM variant in this implementation.

/r

Meaning: Requests the initial sound-output state.

General form:

```
/r[YES|NO]
```

- YES or an empty value: requests sound enabled.
- NO (and any other non-YES non-empty value): requests sound disabled.
- Omitted: requests sound enabled.

Examples:

```
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /r  
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /rNO
```

Consequence: The option is parsed, but the implemented ZX80/ZX81 computer has no sound device, so initialization makes no audio-state change.

/p

Meaning: Connects one or more peripherals during startup.

General form:

```
/pPER1[,PER2...]
```

- 10: typewriter keyboard input.
- 100: Sinclair cassette signal simulation.
- 101: ZX80/ZX81 cassette-data injection.
- 102: ZX Printer thermal-printer simulation.
- 201: cartridge implementation supported by the builder, although it is not listed by POSSIBLEPERS.

Examples:

```
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /p10  
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /p100,102
```

Consequence: Each requested peripheral is built and connected to the first compatible device during emulator initialization. Unsupported IDs are logged and initialization continues.

/g

Meaning: Controls the CRT post-processing effect at startup.

General form:

```
/g[YES|NO]
```

- YES or an empty value: CRT effect enabled.
- NO (and any non-YES non-empty value): disabled.
- Omitted: disabled.

Examples:

```
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /g  
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /gNO
```


Consequence: The screen starts with or without CRT emulation. CRTON and CROFF can change it later.

/n

Meaning: Requests NTSC visualization parameters.

General form:

```
/n
```

- No value: the presence of the option requests NTSC.

Examples:

```
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /mZX813 /n
```

Consequence: The current factory always constructs PAL ZX80 and ZX81 machines. The option is detected and a limitation is written to the log, but PAL timing and screen geometry remain active.

/w

Meaning: Selects the startup RAM configuration.

General form:

```
/wCONF
```

- ZX80: only configuration 0 (unexpanded) is implemented; another value is ignored and logged.
- ZX81 ROM variants, 0 or omitted: unexpanded configuration (default).
- ZX81 ROM variants, 1: 16 KiB expansion.
- ZX81 ROM variants, any value other than 0 or 1: reset to unexpanded configuration and logged.

Examples:

```
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /mZX80 /w0  
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /mZX813 /w1
```

Consequence: The selected memory map is installed before the ROM and machine initialize. The broader 3K/8K/24K list in an old header comment is not implemented by the current factory.

/b

Meaning: Draws a diagnostic grid around the writable screen area and selects its color.

General form:

```
/b[COLOR]
```

- COLOR omitted or 0: black (default).
- 1 through 15: the requested grid color.
- Any value greater than 15: clamped to 15.

Examples:

```
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /b  
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /b14
```

Consequence: The screen is initialized with the diagnostic grid enabled in the selected color.

/m

Meaning: Selects the ZX80 or ZX81 ROM variant to emulate.

General form:

```
/mMACHINE
```

- ZX80: ZX80 model and ROM; this is the default when /m is omitted.
- ZX811: ZX81 with the old ROM image.
- ZX812: ZX81 with the rare/intermediate ROM image.
- ZX813: ZX81 with the newest ROM image.
- Any other value: logs the unsupported selector and falls back to ZX80.

Examples:

```
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /mZX80  
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /mZX811  
ZX81EmulatorC.exe /mZX813 /w1
```

Consequence: The selector chooses the ROM image and machine type created before initialization. It does not independently select a ULA silicon revision, video standard or RAM expansion.

3. Command Console Reference

The local console checks its eleven emulator-level commands first. All remaining text is delegated through ZX81::CommandBuilder, then SINCLAIR::CommandBuilder, and finally MCHEmul::StandardCommandBuilder. The remote /o channel in ZX81Emulator.exe uses only that three-builder chain. The availability line in each entry makes this boundary explicit.

3.1 Standard Framework Commands

HELP

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CHELP.

Meaning: Displays the ZX80/ZX81 console help assembled from the ZX80/ZX81, Sinclair, local-console and standard help files.

General syntax:

```
HELP
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
HELP
```

Result and consequences: Displays the ZX80/ZX81 console help assembled from the ZX80/ZX81, Sinclair, local-console and standard help files.

AUTHOR

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CAUTHOR.

Meaning: Returns framework author information.

General syntax:

```
AUTHOR
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
AUTHOR
```

Result and consequences: Returns framework author information.

STATUS

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CSTATUS.

Meaning: Shows the Z80 status register.

General syntax:

```
STATUS
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
STATUS
```

Result and consequences: Shows the Z80 status register.

PC

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CPC.

Meaning: Shows the current program counter.

General syntax:

```
PC
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
PC
```

Result and consequences: Shows the current program counter.

REGISTERS

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CREGISTERS.

Meaning: Shows all CPU registers.

General syntax:

```
REGISTERS
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
REGISTERS
```

Result and consequences: Shows all CPU registers.

CHANGereg

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CCHANGereg.

Meaning: Changes one CPU internal register.

General syntax:

```
CHANGereg regname value
```

Parameters:

- REGNAME: registered Z80 register name.
- VALUE: new decimal, z-prefixed binary, o-prefixed octal or \$-prefixed hexadecimal value.

Examples:

```
CHANGereg A $41
```

Result and consequences: The register changes only if it exists and accepts the supplied byte width; otherwise an error is returned.

STACK

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CSTACK.

Meaning: Shows stack state.

General syntax:

```
STACK [ALL]
```

Parameters:

- ALL: optional; includes stack contents in addition to basic state.

Examples:

```
STACK  
STACK ALL
```

Result and consequences: Shows stack state.

CPUSTATUS

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CCPUSTATUS.

Meaning: Shows registers, status, program counter and stack.

General syntax:

```
CPUSTATUS
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
CPUSTATUS
```

Result and consequences: Shows registers, status, program counter and stack.

CPUSTATUS

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CCPUSSTATUS.

Meaning: Shows the compact CPU status without stack detail.

General syntax:

```
CPUSSTATUS
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
CPUSSTATUS
```

Result and consequences: Shows the compact CPU status without stack detail.

CPUSTATE

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CCPUSTATE.

Meaning: Shows the CPU execution state and state-specific data.

General syntax:

```
CPUSTATE
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
CPUSTATE
```

Result and consequences: Shows the CPU execution state and state-specific data.

CPUINFO

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CCPUINFO.

Meaning: Returns the complete CPU information structure.

General syntax:

```
CPUINFO
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
CPUINFO
```

Result and consequences: Returns the complete CPU information structure.

MEMORY

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CMEMORY.

Meaning: Reads the active CPU-visible memory range.

General syntax:

```
MEMORY INITIAL [FINAL]
```

Parameters:

- INITIAL: first address.
- FINAL: optional last address; with no final address only the initial location is reported.

Examples:

```
MEMORY $0400  
MEMORY $0400 $0427
```

Result and consequences: Reads the active CPU-visible memory range.

MEMORYDUMP

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CMEMORYDUMP.

Meaning: Dumps every memory view between two addresses, including inactive RAM/ROM views.

General syntax:

```
MEMORYDUMP INITIAL FINAL
```

Parameters:

- INITIAL: first address.
- FINAL: last address.

Examples:

```
MEMORYDUMP $a000 $a03f
```

Result and consequences: Dumps every memory view between two addresses, including inactive RAM/ROM views.

MEMORYSTR

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CMEMORYSTR.

Meaning: Shows the configured memory structure.

General syntax:

```
MEMORYSTR [ALL]
```

Parameters:

- ALL: optional; includes inactive regions. Without it only active regions are shown.

Examples:

```
MEMORYSTR  
MEMORYSTR ALL
```

Result and consequences: Shows the configured memory structure.

SETMEMORY

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CSETMEMORY.

Meaning: Writes a value to one address or repeatedly across a range.

General syntax:

```
SETMEMORY INITIAL [FINAL] VALUE
```

Parameters:

- INITIAL: first address.
- FINAL: optional last address.
- VALUE: byte sequence in framework numeric syntax; multi-byte values advance by their own length.

Examples:

```
SETMEMORY $0400 $41  
SETMEMORY $0400 $0427 $20
```

Result and consequences: The active memory view is modified immediately; unsafe writes can corrupt state or crash the emulated program.

MEMORYANALYSIS

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CMEMORYANALYSIS.

Meaning: Analyzes the current memory configuration.

General syntax:

```
MEMORYANALYSIS
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
MEMORYANALYSIS
```

Result and consequences: Analyzes the current memory configuration.

STOP

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CSTOP.

Meaning: Stops CPU execution.

General syntax:

```
STOP
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
STOP
```

Result and consequences: Stops CPU execution.

RUN

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: R, CRUN.

Meaning: Starts or resumes CPU execution; alias R.

General syntax:

```
RUN [ADDRESS]
```

Parameters:

- ADDRESS: optional new program counter before running.

Examples:

```
RUN  
R $080d
```

Result and consequences: The CPU resumes immediately, optionally after changing PC.

SETPC

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CSETPC.

Meaning: Sets the program counter without starting execution.

General syntax:

```
SETPC ADDRESS
```

Parameters:

- ADDRESS: new CPU address.

Examples:

```
SETPC $080d
```

Result and consequences: Subsequent execution continues from the new address; an unsafe address can break the program.

NEXT

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: N, CNEXT.

Meaning: Executes the next instruction; alias N.

General syntax:

```
NEXT
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
NEXT  
N
```

Result and consequences: Executes the next instruction; alias N.

NEXTSTACK

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: NS, CNEXTSTACK.

Meaning: Runs until the stack pointer returns to its initial value; alias NS.

General syntax:

```
NEXTSTACK
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
NS
```

Result and consequences: Useful for stepping over a routine, although behavior depends on the routine's stack discipline.

SHOWNEXT

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: SN, CSHOWNEXT.

Meaning: Disassembles upcoming instruction(s); alias SN.

General syntax:

```
SHOWNEXT [NUMBER]
```

Parameters:

- NUMBER: optional count; one instruction by default.

Examples:

```
SHOWNEXT  
SN 8
```

Result and consequences: Disassembles upcoming instruction(s); alias SN.

INST

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CINST.

Meaning: Shows the last instruction executed.

General syntax:

```
INST
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
INST
```

Result and consequences: Shows the last instruction executed.

BREAKS

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CBREAKS.

Meaning: Lists all stop-point addresses.

General syntax:

```
BREAKS
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
BREAKS
```

Result and consequences: Lists all stop-point addresses.

SETBREAK

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CSETBREAK.

Meaning: Adds one or more breakpoints.

General syntax:

```
SETBREAK ADDRESS1 [ADDRESS2 ...]
```

Parameters:

- ADDRESSn: one or more addresses in framework numeric syntax.

Examples:

```
SETBREAK $080d $ffd2
```

Result and consequences: Adds one or more breakpoints.

REMOVEBREAK

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CREMOVEBREAK.

Meaning: Removes selected breakpoints.

General syntax:

```
REMOVEBREAK ADDRESS1 [ADDRESS2 ...]
```

Parameters:

- ADDRESSn: one or more existing breakpoint addresses.

Examples:

```
REMOVEBREAK $ffd2
```

Result and consequences: Removes selected breakpoints.

REMOVEBREAKS

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CREMOVEBREAKS.

Meaning: Removes every breakpoint.

General syntax:

```
REMOVEBREAKS
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
REMOVEBREAKS
```

Result and consequences: Removes every breakpoint.

SPEED

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CSPEED.

Meaning: Shows measured CPU and screen-I/O execution speed.

General syntax:

```
SPEED
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
SPEED
```

Result and consequences: Shows measured CPU and screen-I/O execution speed.

LOADBIN

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CLOADBIN.

Meaning: Loads a raw binary file at an explicit address.

General syntax:

```
LOADBIN FILE ADDRESS
```

Parameters:

- FILE: raw binary path.
- ADDRESS: first destination address.

Examples:

```
LOADBIN charset.bin $2000
```

Result and consequences: Bytes are copied into memory without an embedded load-address header.

SAVEBIN

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CSAVEBIN.

Meaning: Saves a memory range as raw binary.

General syntax:

```
SAVEBIN FILE SIZE ADDRESS
```

Parameters:

- FILE: output path.
- SIZE: byte count.
- ADDRESS: first source address.

Examples:

```
SAVEBIN screen.bin 1000 $0400
```

Result and consequences: Saves a memory range as raw binary.

DEBUGON

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CACTIVATEDEEPDEBUG.

Meaning: Enables deep execution debugging.

General syntax:

```
DEBUGON FILE CPU [APPEND] [FILTERS...]
```

Parameters:

- FILE: output log.
- CPU: YES includes CPU execution; NO omits it.
- APPEND: optional YES appends, NO overwrites (default).
- D:START-END or ALLDIR: address filter.
- C:IDs or ALLCHIP: chip filter.
- I:IDs or ALLIO: device filter.
- M:IDs or ALLMEM: memory filter.

Examples:

```
DEBUGON zx81.log YES NO D:$0800-$0fff ALLCHIP ALLIO ALLMEM
```

Result and consequences: Tracing begins with the selected sources and can substantially slow emulation. It cannot coexist with interrupt-only debugging.

DEBUGOFF

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CDESACTIVATEDEEPDEBUG.

Meaning: Stops deep execution debugging.

General syntax:

```
DEBUGOFF
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
DEBUGOFF
```

Result and consequences: Stops deep execution debugging.

IDEBUGON

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CIDEBUGON.

Meaning: Enables interrupt-only debugging.

General syntax:

```
IDEBUGON FILE [APPEND]
```

Parameters:

- FILE: output log.
- APPEND: optional YES appends; NO overwrites (default).

Examples:

```
IDEBUGON interrupts.log NO
```

Result and consequences: Interrupt tracing begins and cannot coexist with deep debugging.

IDEBUGOFF

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CIDEBUGOFF.

Meaning: Stops interrupt-only debugging.

General syntax:

```
IDEBUGOFF
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
IDEBUGOFF
```

Result and consequences: Stops interrupt-only debugging.

RESTART

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CRESTART.

Meaning: Requests a restart and exits the current computer loop so it can be rebuilt.

General syntax:

```
RESTART STOPPED [LEVEL]
```

Parameters:

- STOPPED: YES restarts stopped; NO restarts running.
- LEVEL: optional 0 CPU-only/mild restart (default), 1 computer restart preserving memory, greater than 1 full restart.

Examples:

```
RESTART YES 0
RESTART NO 2
```

Result and consequences: Requests a restart and exits the current computer loop so it can be rebuilt.

DEVICES

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CDEVICES.

Meaning: Shows all or selected I/O devices.

General syntax:

```
DEVICES [ID1 ID2 ...]
```

Parameters:

- IDn: optional device identifiers; with none, all devices are returned.

Examples:

```
DEVICES
DEVICES 1 2
```

Result and consequences: Shows all or selected I/O devices.

PERIPHERALS

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CPERIPHERALS.

Meaning: Shows all or selected connected peripherals.

General syntax:

```
PERIPHERALS [ID1 ID2 ...]
```

Parameters:

- IDn: optional peripheral identifiers; with none, all are returned.

Examples:

```
PERIPHERALS
PERIPHERALS 100
```

Result and consequences: Shows all or selected connected peripherals.

PERCOMMAND

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CPERCMD.

Meaning: Sends a device-specific command to a connected peripheral.

General syntax:

```
PERCOMMAND PERID CMDID [ATTRS...]
```

Parameters:

- PERID: connected peripheral ID.
- CMDID: command ID implemented by that peripheral.
- ATTRS: optional positional attributes forwarded unchanged.

Examples:

```
PERCOMMAND 100 0
```

Result and consequences: The peripheral executes the request if both IDs and its parameter contract are valid; otherwise the answer reports an error.

ASSIGNJOY

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CASSIGNJ.

Meaning: Remaps a joystick identifier.

General syntax:

```
ASSIGNJOY ID NEWID
```

Parameters:

- ID: current joystick ID.
- NEWID: required target ID; using the same ID removes an existing assignment.

Examples:

```
ASSIGNJOY 0 1
```

Result and consequences: Remaps a joystick identifier.

CLOCKFACTOR

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CCLOCKFACTOR.

Meaning: Changes the CPU clock multiplier.

General syntax:

```
CLOCKFACTOR VALUE
```

Parameters:

- VALUE: numeric factor; 1 means normal speed.

Examples:

```
CLOCKFACTOR 2
```

Result and consequences: The emulation pacing target changes; values above one request faster execution.

SOUNDON

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CSOUNDON.

Meaning: Requests that sound output be enabled.

General syntax:

```
SOUNDON
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
SOUNDON
```

Result and consequences: The command is accepted, but the implemented ZX80/ZX81 computer has no sound device, so it produces no state change.

SOUNDOFF

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CSOUNDOFF.

Meaning: Requests that sound output be disabled.

General syntax:

```
SOUNDOFF
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
SOUNDOFF
```

Result and consequences: The command is accepted, but the implemented ZX80/ZX81 computer has no sound device, so it produces no state change.

INTERRUPTS

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CINTERRUPTS.

Meaning: Shows all interrupts known by the computer.

General syntax:

```
INTERRUPTS
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
INTERRUPTS
```

Result and consequences: Shows all interrupts known by the computer.

INTSET

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CINTSET.

Meaning: Enables or disables one interrupt or every interrupt.

General syntax:

```
INTSET ID|ALL ON|OFF
```

Parameters:

- ID or ALL: target interrupt.
- ON or OFF: requested state.

Examples:

```
INTSET ALL ON
```

Result and consequences: An unknown interrupt ID produces an error.

CHIPS

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CCHIPS.

Meaning: Lists the emulated chips and their identifying attributes.

General syntax:

```
CHIPS
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
CHIPS
```

Result and consequences: Lists the emulated chips and their identifying attributes.

CRTON

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CCRTON.

Meaning: Enables the CRT screen effect.

General syntax:

```
CRTON
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
CRTON
```

Result and consequences: Enables the CRT screen effect.

CRTOFF

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CCRTOFF.

Meaning: Disables the CRT screen effect.

General syntax:

```
CRTOFF
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
CRTOFF
```

Result and consequences: Disables the CRT screen effect.

DATASETTE

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CDATASETTE.

Meaning: Shows datasette state when a supported datasette is connected.

General syntax:

```
DATASETTE
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
DATASETTE
```

Result and consequences: Shows datasette state when a supported datasette is connected.

GRIDON

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CGRIDON.

Meaning: Enables the diagnostic grid overlay on the screen.

General syntax:

```
GRIDON COLOR
```

Parameters:

- COLOR: mandatory numeric grid color.

Examples:

```
GRIDON 14
```

Result and consequences: Enables the standard screen grid with the requested color.

GRIDOFF

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CGRIDOFF.

Meaning: Disables the diagnostic grid overlay.

General syntax:

```
GRIDOFF
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
GRIDOFF
```

Result and consequences: Disables the standard screen grid.

PICTURE

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CPICTURE.

Meaning: Saves a screenshot of the emulator screen.

General syntax:

```
PICTURE FILE
```

Parameters:

- FILE: output PNG, JPG or BMP filename.

Examples:

```
PICTURE zx81-screen.png
```

Result and consequences: A supported extension writes the current screen; unsupported formats fail.

SETHOOK

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CSETHOOK.

Meaning: Creates an execution hook.

General syntax:

```
SETHOOK ID TYPE [PARAMS...]
```

Parameters:

- ID: unique hook identifier.
- TYPE: hook kind; currently 0 stops on memory read/write.
- For TYPE 0, PARAMS are mandatory INITIAL and optional FINAL addresses.

Examples:

```
SETHOOK 1 0 $d000 $d3ff
```

Result and consequences: Creates an execution hook.

REMOVEHOOK

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CREMOVEHOOK.

Meaning: Removes a hook by identifier.

General syntax:

```
REMOVEHOOK ID
```

Parameters:

- ID: hook identifier.

Examples:

```
REMOVEHOOK 1
```

Result and consequences: If the hook does not exist, no state changes.

HOOKS

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CHOOKS.

Meaning: Lists active hooks.

General syntax:

```
HOOKS
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
HOOKS
```

Result and consequences: Lists active hooks.

HOOKSHELP

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CHOOKSHELP.

Meaning: Shows help for supported hook types.

General syntax:

```
HOOKSHELP
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
HOOKSHELP
```

Result and consequences: Shows help for supported hook types.

CMOVEPARAMS

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: No public alias.

Meaning: Builds the framework's internal MoveParametersToAnswerCommand.

General syntax:

```
CMOVEPARAMS
```

Parameters:

- No parameters are executable under the current command contract.

Examples:

```
CMOVEPARAMS
```

Result and consequences: The command returns an empty answer when invoked directly; it is an internal response helper and is not advertised in the help file.

3.2 Inherited Sinclair Commands

SYSVARS

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CSYSVARS.

Meaning: Returns every system variable defined for the selected ZX80 or ZX81 ROM profile.

General syntax:

```
SYSVARS
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
SYSVARS
```

Result and consequences: Returns the current values through the system-variable definitions loaded for the selected ROM variant.

SYSVAR

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CSYSVAR.

Meaning: Returns one named system variable.

General syntax:

```
SYSVAR VNAME
```

Parameters:

- VNAME: mandatory variable name from the selected machine's system-variable table.

Examples:

```
SYSVAR D_FILE  
SYSVAR E_LINE
```

Result and consequences: Returns the named variable and its current memory value; an unknown name returns an error entry.

3.3 ZX80/ZX81-Specific Commands

ULA

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CULA.

Meaning: Returns the current ULA and video-generation state.

General syntax:

```
ULA
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
ULA
```

Result and consequences: Returns the ULA state for the selected ZX80 or ZX81 ROM variant, including its current raster and display-generation data.

ULAEVENTS

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CULAEVENTS.

Meaning: Enables or disables visualization of significant CPU/ULA events.

General syntax:

```
ULAEVENTS ON|OFF
```

Parameters:

- ON: enables event visualization.
- OFF: disables it. The implementation accepts any single token; only the exact value ON enables the feature.

Examples:

```
ULAEVENTS ON  
ULAEVENTS OFF
```

Result and consequences: Changes the ULA event-overlay flag used by the active ZX80/ZX81 screen implementation.

DFDUMP

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CDFDUMP.

Meaning: Returns a snapshot of the current display file.

General syntax:

```
DFDUMP
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
DFDUMP
```

Result and consequences: Returns the bytes selected by the active ZX80/ZX81 display-file mapping.

CHARSDRAW

Availability: Local console and remote /o channel.

Accepted aliases: CCHARSDRAW.

Meaning: Returns textual drawings of all or selected character glyphs.

General syntax:

```
CHARSDRAW [0..63 ...]
```

Parameters:

- Character codes: optional values from 0 through 63; out-of-range values are ignored and duplicates are coalesced. With none, all 64 glyphs are rendered.

Examples:

```
CHARSDRAW  
CHARSDRAW 0 1 32 63
```

Result and consequences: Returns textual glyph drawings from the character data visible to the selected ZX80/ZX81 model.

3.4 Local-Console-Only Commands

LOADPRG

Availability: Local console only.

Accepted aliases: None.

Meaning: Loads, assembles and installs an assembler source through the emulator object.

General syntax:

```
LOADPRG FILE
```

Parameters:

- FILE: assembler source path.

Examples:

```
LOADPRG demo.asm
```

Result and consequences: Compilation or loading errors are reported by the local console.

LOADBINARY

Availability: Local console only.

Accepted aliases: None.

Meaning: Loads a binary containing its destination address in the file header.

General syntax:


```
LOADBINARY FILE
```

Parameters:

- FILE: header-addressed binary path.

Examples:

```
LOADBINARY demo.prg
```

Result and consequences: Loads a binary containing its destination address in the file header.

LOADBLOCKS

Availability: Local console only.

Accepted aliases: None.

Meaning: Loads a block-structured memory file.

General syntax:

```
LOADBLOCKS FILE
```

Parameters:

- FILE: block file path.

Examples:

```
LOADBLOCKS state.blocks
```

Result and consequences: Loads a block-structured memory file.

DECOMPILE

Availability: Local console only.

Accepted aliases: None.

Meaning: Disassembles a memory region.

General syntax:

```
DECOMPILE ADDRESS BYTES
```

Parameters:

- ADDRESS: first address.
- BYTES: approximate byte count; output rounds to complete instructions.

Examples:

```
DECOMPILE $080d 64
```

Result and consequences: Disassembles a memory region.

POSSIBLEPERS

Availability: Local console only.

Accepted aliases: None.

Meaning: Lists peripheral IDs and required attributes supported by the active I/O peripheral builder.

General syntax:

```
POSSIBLEPERS
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
POSSIBLEPERS
```

Result and consequences: Lists peripheral IDs and required attributes supported by the active I/O peripheral builder.

CONNECTPER

Availability: Local console only.

Accepted aliases: None.

Meaning: Builds and connects a peripheral to the first compatible device.

General syntax:

```
CONNECTPER ID [ATTRS...]
```

Parameters:

- ID: peripheral-emulation ID from POSSIBLEPERS.
- ATTRS: optional device-specific positional attributes, such as d:8 for a 1541 or d:4 f:printer.ps p:MPS801-PS for a printer.

Examples:

```
CONNECTPER 100  
CONNECTPER 215 d:8
```

Result and consequences: Connection succeeds only when the ID and attributes are valid and a compatible device is available.

DISCONNECTPERS

Availability: Local console only.

Accepted aliases: None.

Meaning: Disconnects one or more peripherals.

General syntax:

```
DISCONNECTPERS ID1 [ID2 ...]
```

Parameters:

- IDn: connected peripheral IDs.

Examples:

```
DISCONNECTPERS 100 101
```

Result and consequences: Disconnects one or more peripherals.

LOADPERDATA

Availability: Local console only.

Accepted aliases: None.

Meaning: Loads media/data into a connected peripheral.

General syntax:

```
LOADPERDATA ID FILE [DEBUGFILE]
```

Parameters:

- ID: connected peripheral ID.
- FILE: supported media/data file.
- DEBUGFILE: optional file used to start format-related debugging.

Examples:

```
LOADPERDATA 215 disk.d64
```

Result and consequences: The operation fails if the peripheral does not support the supplied format.

EMPTYPERDATA

Availability: Local console only.

Accepted aliases: None.

Meaning: Creates empty media/data in a peripheral.

General syntax:

```
EMPTYPERDATA ID FILE
```

Parameters:

- ID: connected peripheral ID.
- FILE: path whose extension selects a supported creatable format.

Examples:

```
EMPTYPERDATA 215 blank.d64
```

Result and consequences: Only peripherals and formats that implement empty-media creation can succeed.

SAVEPERDATA

Availability: Local console only.

Accepted aliases: None.

Meaning: Saves a peripheral's current media/data.

General syntax:

```
SAVEPERDATA ID [FILE]
```

Parameters:

- ID: connected peripheral ID.
- FILE: optional output path; may be omitted when LOADPERDATA or EMPTYPERDATA established the current filename.

Examples:

```
SAVEPERDATA 215  
SAVEPERDATA 215 copy.d64
```

Result and consequences: Saves a peripheral's current media/data.

CLEARPERDATA

Availability: Local console only.

Accepted aliases: None.

Meaning: Clears all data currently loaded into peripherals.

General syntax:

```
CLEARPERDATA
```

Parameters:

- No parameters.

Examples:

```
CLEARPERDATA
```

Result and consequences: Commonly used to force a subsequent program/media reload.

Appendices

Appendix A. Command Availability Summary

The table distinguishes the interactive console from the command channel of the non-console executable. Remote availability assumes ZX81Emulator.exe was started with /o and that the client is connected.

Command family	ZX81EmulatorC local console	ZX81Emulator remote /o
Standard builder	Yes	Yes
Inherited Sinclair builder	Yes	Yes
ZX80/ZX81 builder	Yes	Yes
LocalConsole emulator/media operations	Yes	No

Appendix B. Source-of-Truth Maintenance Rule

This file is a maintained repository artifact. Every change that adds, removes, renames or changes a ZX80/ZX81 startup option, a command-builder registration, a LocalConsole-only command, command syntax, parameter meaning, command consequences or user-visible formatted output must include a review and, when applicable, an update of docs/ZX81Data/ZX81Emulator_UserGuide.docx. The corresponding canonical .fmt source must be updated whenever the command's InfoStructure contract changes.

Audit the complete chain, not only the edited class: the ZX81Emulator entry point and ZX81::ZX81Emulator hierarchy for startup options; LocalConsole for local-only commands; and ZX81::CommandBuilder -> SINCLAIR::CommandBuilder -> MCHEmul::StandardCommandBuilder for builder commands.

Illustrations

NO ILLUSTRATIONS ARE INCLUDED IN THIS EDITION.

IGNACIO CEA FORNIÉS

Equations

NO EQUATIONS ARE INCLUDED IN THIS EDITION.

IGNACIO CEA FORNIÉS